Lloyd and Ross Taylor, both on 58.

More importantly, *we* make progress and defeat Bangladesh by an innings and 48 runs.

Sunday, 21 December 2008

Please forgive me
If I act a little strange
For I know not what I do

I am arriving at the Western Australian Cricket Association (WACA) for the fifth day of the first Test between Australia and South Africa, and the lyrics of David Gray, the English indie rock singer-songwriter, are flooding my senses via my headphones. I love his music. My whole family loves his music. It is pure and clean and beautiful, and it always gets me in the zone to perform because, against all the odds, against all the precedents in cricket history, we glimpse an extraordinary triumph.

Feels like lightning running through my veins
Every time I look at you

The numbers are simple. We are preparing to resume our innings at 227 for three, chasing an all-but-impossible target of 414 runs to win. We need only 187 more runs. It doesn't seem much, until you count them down one by one. Then it seems a lot. Then, when you factor in the deteriorating pitch, the widening cracks and the uneven bounce, and an Australian team genuinely expecting they will close down another routine win, then 187 more runs begins to feel like a chasm, a divide between what seems possible but never happens.

Jacques Kallis and I are batting. He is 33 not out. I am 11 not out. We